

Akella Raghavendra Sir
Founder & Chief Mentor

[GS PAPER I – INDIAN SOCIETY • GS PAPER II – GOVERNANCE • GS PAPER III – ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY, INFRASTRUCTURE, ECONOMY]

Publication Date: 22/09/2026

Urban Waste Management and Legacy Dumpsite Remediation



India's urban waste-management efforts are shifting from conventional dumping towards scientific legacy dumpsite remediation, resource recovery and sustainable land use under SBM-U 2.0. Case studies from Gorakhpur, Bhalswa, Nagpur and Raichur highlight how reclaimed dumpsites can become eco-parks, processing facilities and ecological spaces.

Urban Waste Management and Legacy Dumpsite Remediation

Syllabus areas:

GS Paper I – Indian Society

GS Paper II – Governance

GS Paper III – Environment & Ecology, Infrastructure, Economy

Urban cleanliness depends on an extensive waste-management system handling waste from households, markets, institutions, commercial establishments and public spaces. Over time, accumulated waste at dumpsites creates **legacy waste sites**. To address urban sanitation challenges, the **Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban (SBM-U)** was launched in October 2014, gradually expanding its focus from basic sanitation to scientific waste management.

Under **SBM-U 2.0**, launched in October 2021, cities are working to scientifically remediate legacy dumpsites and convert them into productive, environmentally sustainable spaces. Between January and December 2025, **3.66 crore metric tonnes of legacy waste** were remediated, while **459 Urban Local Bodies across 29 States** achieved complete dumpsite remediation. The **Lakshya Zero Dumpsite** initiative is driving this time-bound transformation across cities and States.



Case Study: Kachre Se Kanchan Rapti Eco Park, Gorakhpur

A 40-acre dumpsite in Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh, accumulated municipal waste for seven years. Through scientific **biomining**, waste was processed into fuel, black soil and inert material. The reclaimed site was transformed into **Kachre Se Kanchan Rapti Eco Park**, featuring green spaces, recreation facilities, solar lighting and water conservation structures, while supporting livelihoods through **Shakti Ki Rasoi**.



Case Study: Bhalswa Dumpsite, Delhi

The **70-acre Bhalswa dumpsite** has undergone continuous biomining since July 2022. Under the **Dumpsite Remediation Accelerator Programme (DRAP)**, launched in 2025, remediation was accelerated. By July 2026, **99.07 lakh metric tonnes** of legacy waste had been processed, with over half the site reclaimed, alongside fire prevention, leachate management and measures to prevent fresh waste accumulation.



Case Study: Bhandewadi, Nagpur

Nagpur transformed the **Bhandewadi dumping yard** from a legacy waste site into an **Integrated Municipal Waste Processing Facility**. Over **10 lakh metric tonnes of accumulated waste** have been scientifically excavated and treated, reclaiming valuable land. The facility now enables material recovery, composting and waste-derived fuel production, supported by dust control, leachate treatment and real-time monitoring.



Case Study: Yakalaspura Dumpsite, Raichur

In **Raichur, Karnataka**, the 35-acre Yakalaspura dumpsite is being transformed through scientific legacy waste remediation. About **62,252 metric tonnes of waste** have been processed, reclaiming nearly **22 acres**. Around 5–7 acres now support a **Miyawaki forest**, with 60,000 bamboo and native saplings planted from June 2026, promoting biodiversity and sustainable urban development under **"Toxic Waste to Ecological Wealth."**



The Movement beyond Clean up:

A reclaimed dumpsite is more than recovered land. It represents a changing approach to managing the waste generated by cities. Across Gorakhpur, Delhi, Nagpur and Raichur, the pattern is the same. Waste mountains are excavated, sorted and turned back into usable land.

Machines and plants alone cannot make this last. City Solid Waste Action Plans, progress on the SBM-U portal and annual Swachh Survekshan rankings keep the work on course long after the ribbon is cut. Infrastructure and institutions together turn a one-time clean up into a lasting system. Swachh Bharat Mission—Urban began with sanitation, but it has grown well beyond it. It is now reshaping how cities reclaim land, restore ecology and build public spaces where people live, work and gather.